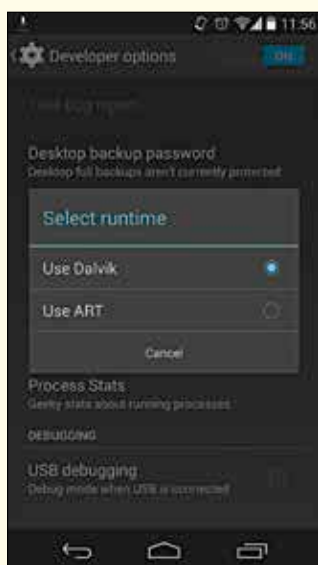




The ART environment saves battery life

cessor power as well as battery power. ART, on the other hand, uses the 'Ahead-of-time' (AOT) process, which keeps all apps compiled and ready to be run before they're launched, thus consuming less processor and battery power, and enabling quicker and smoother launches.

You can activate the ART environment from Settings > Developer options > Select runtime > Use ART

While it is recommended that you stick to Dalvik, it won't hurt to give this new runtime environment a spin.

See performance and usage stats of all processes

KitKat shows you what's going on behind the scenes through the interface of your device. This includes performance and usage statistics of all the background, foreground and cached processes.

To see it, go to Settings > System > Developer options > Process Stats

Here you can set custom duration for the stats, show or hide background, foreground and cached processes and select stats type.

Get cozy with T9 dialing

T9 dialing or dial-pad autocomplete is a very handy feature that lets you type numbers representing the alphabetical characters of your contact names in the dialer. You don't have to scroll down the entire list of contacts or add them to quick dialer anymore; this feature can act as a quick dial option for any contact.

To try it, tap the dialer icon located at the bottom of your screen, then type the numbers representing the alphabetical characters of your contacts' names.

Use the integrated Quickoffice

The Quickoffice app – Microsoft Office's styled suite that lets you easily handle your office tasks – comes pre-installed with Android 4.4. This means that you don't have to download any third-party app or pay.

You can easily edit or create documents, spreadsheets or presentations, view PDF files and save them on the cloud-based Google Drive storage service. This feature will serve you best for creating documents and doing light editing on the go.



T9 dialing gives you quick access to contacts

Use the advanced file picker

Google introduced an advanced file picker in Android 4.4 that makes file picking easy and comprehensive. Since it's integrated with Google Drive and other third-party cloud services, you can pick files from there. In addition to this, the advanced file picker lets you pick files from internal storage and the external SD card as well.

You'll need to turn on the advanced features as it's not turned on by default. To do this, go to Settings > Storage > Audio > More (three dots) > Settings > Display advanced devices

Once this is enabled, your internal storage and SD card (if you have one) will appear in the menu. Now, you can select any file located on the internal storage or SD card.

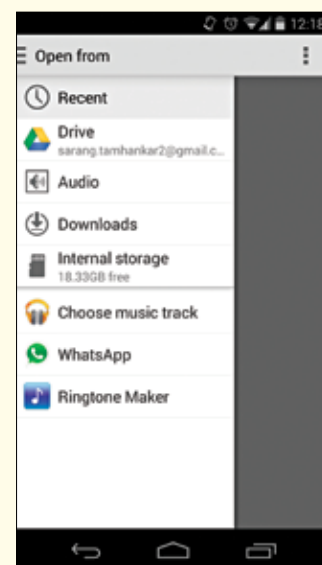
The immersive mode

Android devices no longer use the physical capacitive buttons; instead, these buttons appear as soft keys on the screen. The buttons may irk you with their presence on the screen while watching movies or reading a book.

To get rid of this, Google introduced the Immersive mode to hide these soft keys while you're watching a video or reading a book. Just launch a movie player or book reader and then tap the screen to hide the soft keys.

Zooming in with one finger in Gmail, Maps and Chrome

Android 4.4 lets you go beyond pinch-to-zoom in Google apps. You can now zoom within the apps using one finger, which comes handy in situations where you have only one hand free to hold your phone.



Some of the sources from which you can pick files

To do this, open either Gmail, Maps or Chrome, then double tap, hold and drag your finger. We tried it and it works like a charm. Alongside, the pinch-to-zoom feature also works.

Save battery with new GPS modes

Any instance of data fetching from the GPS chip turns out to be quite battery consuming.

To avoid this, we can simply turn off the GPS, but this isn't convenient. With Android 4.4, you get a convenient feature that lets you choose from between different modes such as High accuracy, Battery saving and Device only.

The Battery saving mode will use Wi-Fi and mobile networks to estimate location, and this in turn will save battery without sacrificing the GPS capabilities.

To select a mode, go to Settings > Location > Mode > Battery Saving

Do high speed scrubbing from the lock screen

The lock screen is integrated with music controls, which includes Play/Pause and Skip buttons. In addition to this,